James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Community and go-to-market operator who builds the programs, content and measurement that grow technical communities, and who builds with AI tools every day. At Cecure Intelligence I built a community of 20,000+ members and onboarded 10,000+ users to a technical training academy across five African countries, with AWS, Google and Microsoft as partners, at under $0.50 per customer. I run the Marketing In Action newsletter (5,000+ subscribers across 86 countries, 47.5% average open rate), a WhatsApp community for marketers and Marketing & Chill, a meetup in Lagos for 60 to 80 marketers twice a year. I am a Claude Community Ambassador for Anthropic, and I publish 34 of my 81 agent skills on GitHub with a beginner guide so other marketers can install them. I gave a keynote at the CIL x AWS Lagos Executive Cloud Technology Summit 2023, and I work remotely with distributed teams. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/pytorch-foundation.

Selected Achievements:

- Built a community of **20,000+ members** and onboarded **10,000+ academy users** in the first cohort across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola at **under $0.50 customer acquisition cost**, with AWS, Google and Microsoft as partners.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers across 86 countries at a 47.5% average open rate**, built a WhatsApp community around it and co-host Marketing & Chill in Lagos.
- Lead local Claude community activity through events and workshops as a **Claude Community Ambassador** for Anthropic, and mentor marketers at ADMARP, the Association of Digital Marketing Professionals.
- Published **34 agent skills** on GitHub with a beginner guide repo, and run my newsletter and content calendar on scheduled agents that draft, with a person approving every post.
- Ran events and partnerships at Bujeti that produced **200+ of 1,331 marketing qualified leads** in six months, and planned FunnelEnvy's first webinar: **41 registrations, 29% attendance and 39 new newsletter subscribers**.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Community Programs, Ambassador and Mentor Programs, Event Strategy, Content Calendars, Multi-Market Growth, Partnerships, Performance Reporting, Stakeholder Reporting

Execution: Meetups and Webinars, Newsletter and Community Platforms, Educational Content, AI Agent Workflows, Social Publishing, Campaign Tracking, Playbook Documentation, Remote Team Facilitation

Tools: Claude Code, GitHub, WhatsApp, Substack, HubSpot, n8n, Google Workspace, GA4, Looker Studio, Brevo, Customer.io

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and community)

- Run the newsletter on Claude Code skills: one approved issue becomes platform drafts for Substack, X and LinkedIn, I approve each before it publishes, and a daily job logs every live post. 5,000+ subscribers, 47.5% average open rate.
- Built the WhatsApp community for marketers and co-host Marketing & Chill in Lagos twice a year for 60 to 80 marketers, founders and creators.
- Run the content calendar on scheduled agents: twice-daily briefs of candidate posts, approved posts published at set times on four channels, and a skill that drafts pre-event and post-event posts for each channel.
- Built and use 81 agent skills for positioning, content, SEO, paid and analytics work, and published 34 on GitHub with a beginner guide.
- Deliver client work through a system other specialists run on: 10 client engagements, 3 specialists, review gates before anything goes live.

Claude Community Ambassador | Anthropic | Mar 2026 – Present

- Lead local Claude community activity through events and workshops as part of Anthropic's ambassador program.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Ran the product-led growth funnel as the main in-house marketer: 34% lift in trial activation and 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion across web, email and in-app.
- Defined the activation, engagement and retention metrics and built the experimentation framework: 40% shorter experiment cycles.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Planned and hosted the first company webinar: 41 registrations, 29% attendance, 39 new newsletter subscribers.
- Launched a newsletter at a 48% average open rate and built agentic content infrastructure with review gates at each stage: 10+ distribution outputs from one asset.
- Built a cross-brand measurement stack (GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash, HubSpot): 50% faster reporting.

GTM & Product Marketing Consultant | Komfot Health | Nov 2025 – Mar 2026
Komfot Health (B2C and B2B2C digital health on WhatsApp, Nigeria, Rwanda, Benin)

- Audited the acquisition channels and defined the go-to-market structure for three countries.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Ran events and partnerships behind 200+ of 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months, including a founder webinar series and the Bujeti x TheCANS Solution Showcase.
- Grew B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024, with 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn from redesigned lifecycle flows.

CRO & Demand Generation Manager | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Launched the CIL Academy across five countries: 20,000+ community members, 10,000+ users onboarded in the first cohort, under $0.50 customer acquisition cost.
- Gave a keynote at the CIL x AWS Lagos Executive Cloud Technology Summit 2023 and ran online and offline events for the company.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads and 406 sales qualified leads across Sub-Saharan Africa, with partnerships across AWS, Google and Microsoft.

Growth & Product Marketing Manager | Bento Africa | Jan 2022 – Dec 2022
Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya and Rwanda)

- Built a lead scoring system and nurture programs: 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion.

Marketing & Growth Advisor | JegzFits Leatherworks | 2021 – Present
JegzFits Leatherworks (Nigerian consumer brand, handmade leather goods)

- Run Meta and TikTok paid social at about 6.5x return on ad spend, held while spend increased.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0